Automate mix and effects settings

Overview of automation in Logic Pro for Mac

Automation refers to recording, editing, and playing back the movements of faders, knobs, and switches. Using automation, you can create changes over time to volume, pan, and other settings. You can add automation to all track types.

Each track in your project has automation curves for volume and pan, and you can add curves to automate plug-in settings. To create changes over time, you do the following:

- Show the automation curve you want to work on, and choose between track automation and region automation.
- Choose an automation mode.
- Add automation points to the curve at the start and end points for the change you want, then adjust the automation points.

You can also snap automation to positions in the grid and edit automation in the Automation Event List.

Track automation vs. region automation in Logic Pro for Mac

Logic Pro for Mac offers two types of automation: *track automation* and *region automation*. Track automation can be applied to the entire track, from the beginning to the end of your project. Region automation applies only to the specific region the automation parameters are connected to. With track automation, if you re-record, move, or copy regions (either to another point on the same track or to another track entirely) the automation data remains tied to the initial point on the track in which it was created. However, with region automation, if you re-record the region, the automation is lost; if you move or copy the region (either to another point on the same track, or to another track) the automation remains with the region. Region automation is particularly useful when you are automating instrument parameters.

When using region automation with instrument tracks, you can also automate MIDI data for individual notes. In addition, you can also convert track automation to region automation and vice versa.

A single track can have track automation on the track, and regions on that track with region automation. To switch between which type of automation to view, see Switch between track automation and region automation.

Note: In previous versions of Logic Pro for Mac, MIDI Draw was used to automate MIDI data for individual notes. Region automation includes all the functionality of MIDI Draw.

Convert between types of automation

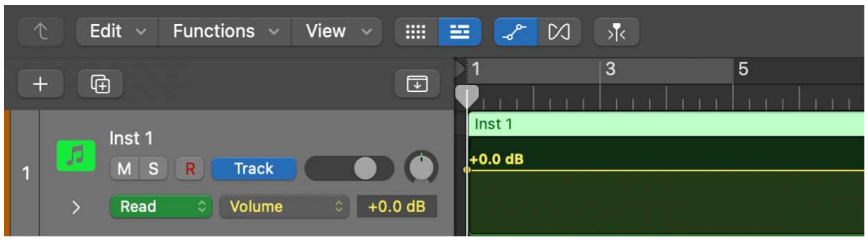
In Logic Pro, choose one of the following commands from the Mix > Convert Automation submenu:

- *Convert Visible Track Automation to Region Automation:* Converts displayed track automation to region automation.
- *Convert Visible Region Automation to Track Automation:* Converts displayed region automation to track automation.
- *Convert All Track Automation to Region Automation:* Converts all track automation to region automation, regardless if it is currently visible onscreen.
- *Convert All Region Automation to Track Automation:* Converts all region automation to track automation, regardless if it is currently visible onscreen.

Note: These commands all have assignable key commands as well.

Show automation curves in Logic Pro for Mac

Before you can add automation points to a track's automation curves, you need to show the automation curves. Automation curves are displayed as color-coded curves and points on top of audio and MIDI regions across the track, running the length of the project. You can choose whether to view and edit automation across the track (track automation) or only within the track's regions (region automation).



After you show the automation curves, you can choose which parameter you want to work with—Volume, Pan, or any other track parameter. You can work with multiple parameters on the same track by switching between automation curves using the Automation Parameter pop-up menu, or you can work in separate automation lanes, which appear below the main track.

Show automation curves

- In Logic Pro, do one of the following:
  - Choose Mix > Show Automation (or press A).
  - Click the Show/Hide Automation button in the Tracks area menu bar.

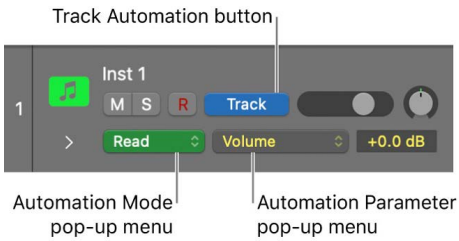
  An Automation button, an Automation Parameter pop-up menu, and an Automation Mode pop-up menu appear in each track header. When you choose an automation mode, for most automation modes the background color of the Automation Mode pop-up menu reflects the mode:

- Gray background = automation is off
- Mustard background = Touch mode
- Orange background = Latch mode
- Purple = Write mode

For Read mode, however, the button and text color reflect the current state of automation and whether there is automation data present:

- Green text on a gray background = automation is on but there is no existing automation data to display
- White text on a green background = automation is on and there is existing automation data to display

Any existing automation is displayed on the track or within the regions. If you show automation on a collapsed track stack, all the automation from included tracks is displayed. You can choose the parameter you want to automate—Volume fader, Pan knob, or any other track parameter—from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu.



Switch between track automation and region automation

After you show automation curves, you can easily switch between track automation and region automation. See Track automation vs. region automation for details on the differences between the two types of automation.

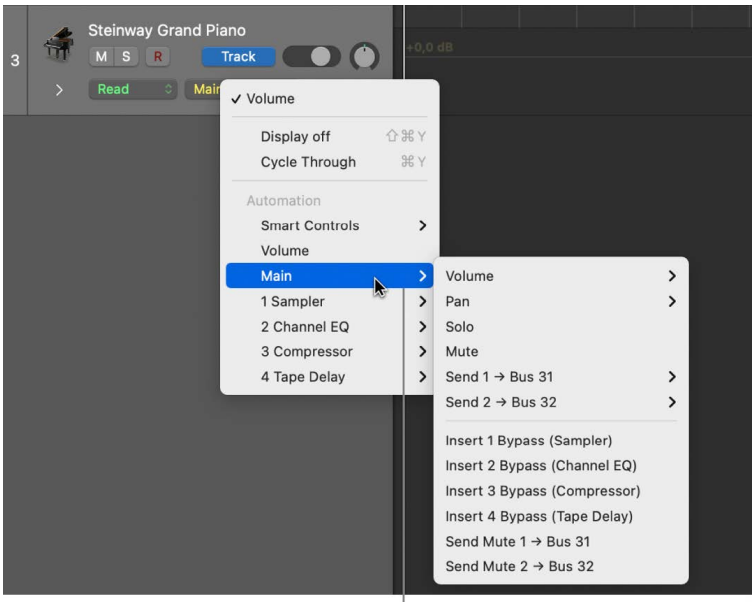
- In Logic Pro, click the Automation button in the track header to switch between track automation and region automation.



Choose the parameter to automate

In Logic Pro, do one of the following:

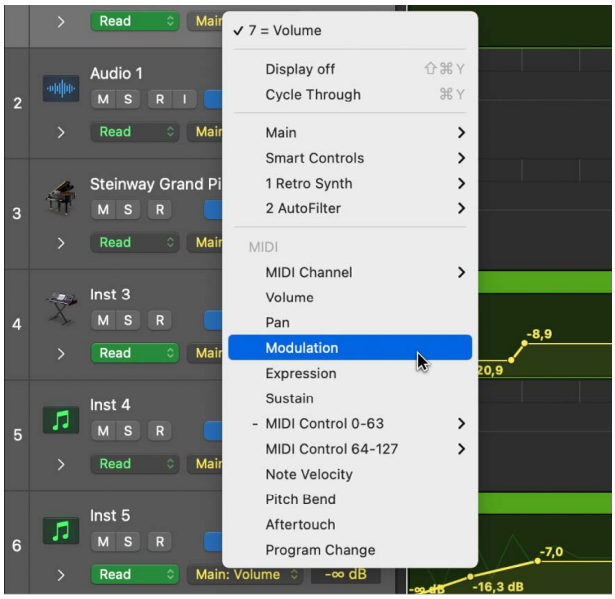
- Choose a parameter from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu in the track header.



- Control-click the track lane, then choose an automation parameter from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu in the shortcut menu that appears.

The parameter currently shown in the automation lane is shown at the top of the Automation Parameter pop-up menu. Volume, Pan, Solo, and Mute appear in the “Main” submenu. A submenu is also shown for Smart Controls; for more information on automating Smart Controls, see automate screen control movements.

Below the Smart Controls submenu, the Automation Parameter pop-up menu contains a submenu for each plug-in on the track. The plug-in submenus are numbered and named after the slot position and plug-in: 1 Sampler, for example. When using region automation with an instrument, a MIDI sub-section shows all available MIDI parameters available for you to automate.



Note: Logic Pro offers more than two dozen unassigned key commands that you can use to select the automation curves of various region automation parameters directly. You can assign these key commands to keys, controllers, or a Touch Pad using the Key Commands window. When you select one or more regions and then use one of these key commands, the chosen automation curve is shown on all tracks with regions selected. If you use one of these key commands without any regions selected, the selected track shows the chosen automation curve. See Assign key commands.

Automatically select which automation parameter to display

You can automatically show the automation curve of any parameter you click in a channel strip, plug-in editor, or track header on the main automation lane.

- In Logic Pro, choose Mix > Autoselect Automation Parameter in Read Mode (or use the Toggle Autoselect Automation Parameter in Read Mode key command).

Automation must show in the main automation lane, and the automation mode must be set to Read, for "Autoselect Automation Parameter in Read Mode" to work. See Choose automation modes to learn more about the automation modes.

Mute an automation parameter curve

You can mute an individual automation parameter by turning it off in the track header.

1. In Logic Pro, choose a parameter from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu in the track header.

2. Place the pointer over the Automation Parameter pop-up menu, then click the On/Off button that appears.



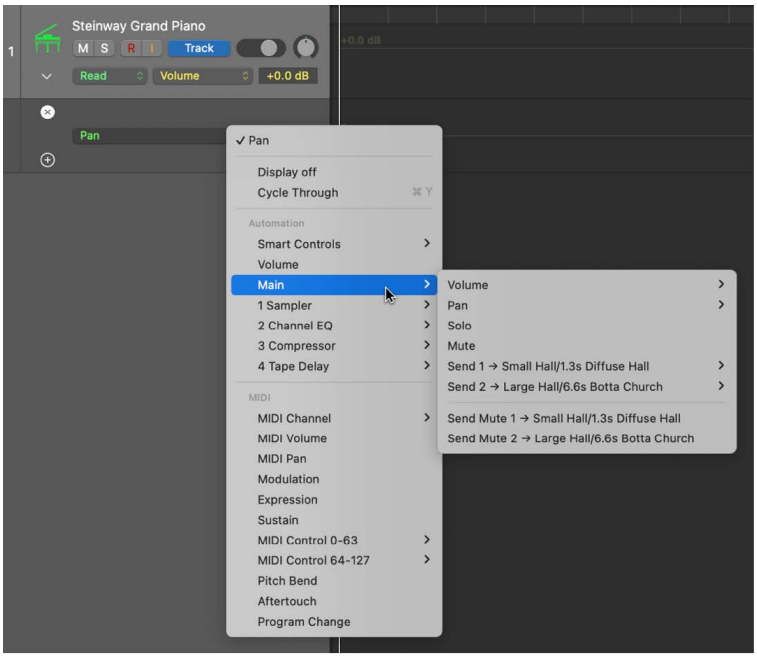
When muted, the automation curve for the parameter turns gray.

Show multiple parameter curves on automation lanes

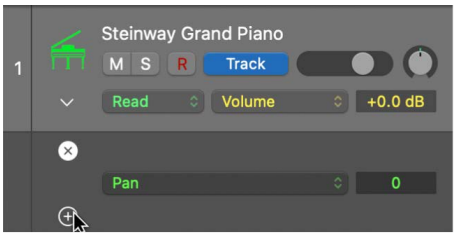
1. In Logic Pro, click the disclosure arrow at the lower left of a track header.



2. Choose the parameter that you want to automate from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu in the track header.



3. To add additional automation lanes, click the Plus button (+) that appears when you place the pointer over the track header.

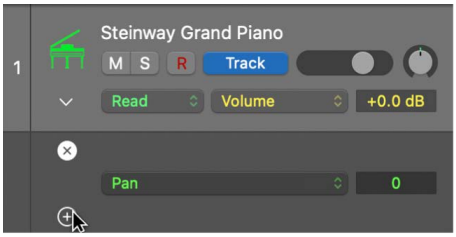


All additional automation lanes are revealed. Each additional lane is set to an automation parameter type that's already recorded but not currently shown. The active automation parameter remains on the main track.

Add, remove, and reorder automation lanes

In Logic Pro, do any of the following:

- *To add an automation lane:* Place the pointer over the automation lane header, then click the Plus (+) that appears.



- *To remove an automation lane:* Place the pointer over the automation lane header, then click the X icon that appears.

  The selected lane is removed without deleting its automation.

- *To reorder automation lanes:* Click an empty part of the automation lane header, then drag it up or down.

Show or hide automation lanes with used automation data

In Logic Pro, do any of the following:

- *To show automation subtracks (that were previously visible) or hide them:* Click the disclosure triangle or use the key command for Toggle Automation Subtracks.
- To *show all previously visible automation lanes:* Use the key command for Show Automation Subtracks.
- *To hide all automation lanes:* Use the key command for Hide Automation Subtracks.
- *To show all automation lanes that contain automation data:* Option-click the disclosure triangle or use the key command for Reset Automation Subtracks.

Note: The commands apply to all selected tracks.

Tip: You may find it easier to work with automation curves at a higher zoom level. To do so, drag the lower edge of the track header downward.

Choose automation modes in Logic Pro for Mac

Automation modes determine how automation tracks are treated. Automation is either being read or being written. You can independently set the automation mode for each track. You can also trim automation values and record relative automation data.

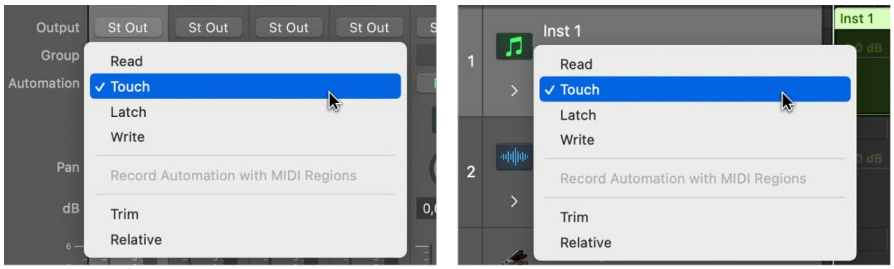
- *Read:* Plays back all automation that exists on the track. If volume data exists, for example, the Volume fader moves during playback, following the prerecorded automation on the track. You can't change the value of the chosen automation parameter by moving controls when in Read mode. However, you can record region information directly into a MIDI region in Read mode.

- *Touch:* Plays back automation in the same way as Read mode. You can modify the value of the chosen automation parameter by moving controls in Touch mode. After the fader or knob is released, the parameter follows existing automation on the track.
- *Latch:* Works like Touch mode, but after the fader or knob is released, the new parameter value replaces existing automation on the track.
- *Write:* Erases existing automation on the track as the playhead passes over it. Records the new control movement or deletes the existing data if you do nothing.
- *Trim:* Offsets the value of the existing automation (Volume, Pan, Send levels) by adjusting it up or down by the amount you move the fader or control. Works in combination with Touch and Latch automation modes.
- *Relative:* Adds a secondary automation curve that offsets the existing primary curve for the selected parameter. There are three channel strip parameters for which you can create relative automation: Volume, Pan, and Send levels. When both relative and absolute automation exists for one of these parameters, both curves are visible and can be edited separately. Relative automation mode works in combination with Touch, Latch, and Write automation modes.

Set the automation mode for a track

In Logic Pro, do one of the following:

- Show the track's automation curves, then choose a mode from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header.
- Choose a mode from the Automation Mode pop-up menu on a track's channel strip.



Set the same automation mode for selected tracks

In Logic Pro, do one of the following:

- Shift-click track headers to select them, then choose a mode from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in one of the track headers.
- Shift-click channel strips in the Mixer to select them, then choose a mode from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in one of the selected channel strips.

Set the automation modes using key commands

In Logic Pro, you can set the automation mode using the following key commands:

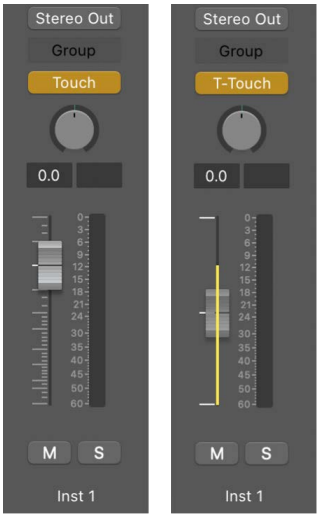
- Toggle Current Track Automation Off/Read
- Set Current Track to Automation Read
- Toggle Current Track Automation Touch/Read
- Toggle Current Track Automation Latch/Read

- Toggle Current Track Automation Write/Read
- Set All Tracks to Automation Off
- Set All Tracks to Automation Read
- Set All Tracks to Automation Touch
- Set All Tracks to Automation Latch
- Set All Tracks to Automation Write

Use Trim Automation mode

1. In Logic Pro, choose Touch or Latch from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header or the track's channel strip.
2. Choose Trim from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header or the track's channel strip.

   Either T-Touch or T-Latch appears in the Automation Mode display. The Volume fader moves to a center position and the fader becomes transparent.

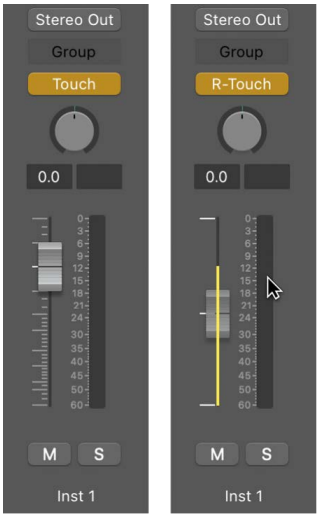


Now when you move the Volume fader during playback, it does not write completely new volume automation data but adjusts it proportionally to the existing data.

Use Relative Automation mode

1. In Logic Pro, choose Touch, Latch, or Write from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header or the track's channel strip.
2. Choose Relative from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header or the track's channel strip.

Either R-Touch, R-Latch, or R-Write appears in the Automation Mode display. The Volume fader moves to a center position and the fader becomes transparent.



Relative automation is only available for the following parameters: Volume, Pan, and Send level.

Consolidate Relative and Absolute automation curves

If you don’t need to edit relative and absolute automation curves separately, you may want to tidy up your automation curves by consolidating absolute and relative automation curves into the same curve.

- In Logic Pro, with automation curves shown, Control-click the track header and choose Consolidate Relative and Absolute [Parameter] Automation from the shortcut menu.

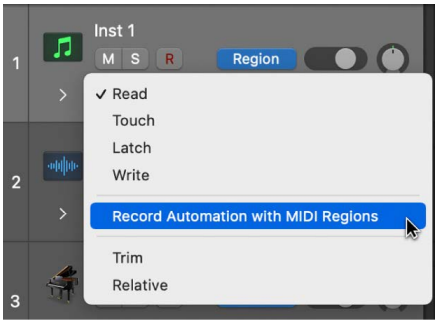
Consolidating the relative and absolute curves has no effect on automation playback.

Record region automation when in Read mode

By default, region automation data is recorded into Audio and MIDI regions even if the track is in Read mode. You can turn this feature on or off for the currently selected track or for all current and future tracks of the same type.

- In Logic Pro, choose either Record Automation with Audio Regions (for audio tracks) or Record Automation with MIDI Regions (for software instrument tracks) from the Automation Mode pop-up menu in the track header or on the channel strip of an audio or software instrument track.

A dialog appears, asking whether you want to apply the change to the current track or to all tracks of the same type.

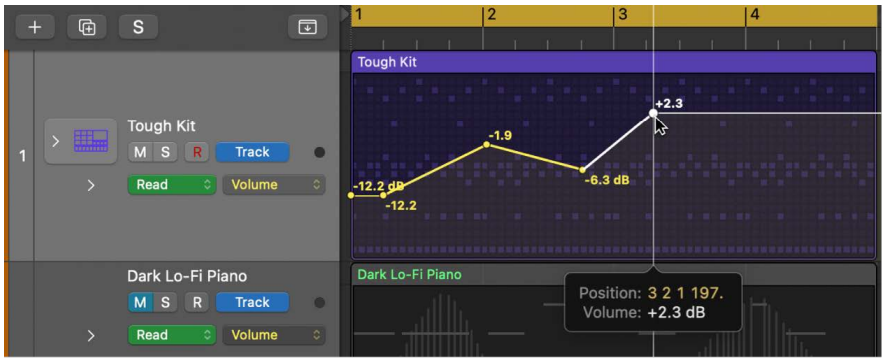


Tip: Press and hold the Option key while choosing a Record Automation option from the menu to turn region automation recording on or off for all current and future tracks of the same type.

Add automation to tracks

Add automation points to tracks in Logic Pro for Mac

To create changes over time to volume, pan, and effects settings, you add automation points to a track's automation curve at different places, and then adjust the automation points so the value of the setting changes. You can adjust automation points by moving them up or down to a new value or by moving them left or right to a new point in the timeline. Numerical values are displayed alongside each automation point. You can also raise or lower the value of MIDI parameters associated with notes in instrument tracks. Note and numerical values are displayed alongside each MIDI data point. You can also add automation points at selection area or region borders.



When splitting a region containing region automation, automation points are automatically added to the automation curves of the original region and the new region at the point of the split. These new points can then be adjusted and moved to create new changes over time for the new region. For more information on splitting regions, see Split regions.

Add one or more automation points to an automation curve

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do any of the following:

- *To add an automation point to an empty automation curve:* Click anywhere in the automation track.

  This adds an automation point at the project start position, using the current fader value.

- *To add an automation point to an existing automation curve, do any of the following:*
  - Click the automation curve.
  - Double-click an empty area of the automation track.
  - Click on or outside the automation curve with the Pencil tool.

  All of these actions add an automation point at the clicked position.

Add a series of MIDI data points using region automation

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, and a MIDI controller data parameter showing in the Automation Parameter pop-up menu, drag a line across the portion of the region.

  New MIDI data is created. If Velocity is the chosen MIDI controller data parameter, new MIDI data is created at every point at which notes intersect the line you drew.

Add a series of automation points using the Pencil tool

You can use the Pencil tool to draw multiple automation points on an automation curve.

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, drag the Pencil tool across the automation curve.

The organization of automation points depends upon the Pencil tool setting in the Automation settings. You have two options:

- *Hold Option for Stepped Editing:* In this mode, dragging with the Pencil tool creates a series of automation points in a curved formation, and Option-dragging creates a series of automation points in a stepped formation.
- *Hold Option for Curved Editing:* In this mode, dragging with the Pencil tool creates a series of automation points in a stepped formation, and Option-dragging creates a series of automation points in a curved formation.

Add automation points at marquee borders

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, drag across a region with the Marquee tool, then click the marquee selection.

Add automation points at region borders

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do either of the following:

- *To add one automation point at each region border:* Select the region, then choose Mix > Create Track Automation > Create 1 Automation Point at Region Borders.
- *To add two automation points at each region border:* Select the region, then choose Mix > Create Track Automation > Create 2 Automation Points at Region Borders.

Add automation points at selection borders

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do either of the following:

- *To add one automation point at each selection border:* Press Option-Shift, then drag the selection across an automation curve.

- *To add two automation points at each selection border:* Press Control-Option-Shift, then drag the selection across an automation curve.

Record live automation in Logic Pro for Mac

When either Touch, Latch, or Write mode is active, you can record automation in record or playback mode. When you touch or move a parameter, the automation lane displays the chosen parameter and automation is recorded at the current point in the project as the playhead moves, based on the chosen mode. When not recording or playing, the modes are ignored, and no data is written if a control is moved.

You have the following Write options for track automation:

- Move any fader or control on the selected channel strip with the automation mode set to Touch, Latch, or Write. In real-world usage, you'll rarely (if ever) use the destructive Write mode, which erases all automation. The standard Write modes are Touch and Latch.
- Choose a parameter from the Automation Parameter pop-up menu in the track header, then adjust the numerical display in the track header, with one of the modes turned on.
- Move the faders or knobs of a connected hardware controller, with one of the modes turned on.
- Use the Pointer or Pencil tool to draw your automation curve.

When you record track automation in Touch, Latch, or Write mode, the automation is written to the track, and the automation curve of the parameter you are adjusting is automatically displayed in the main automation lane.

When you record region automation in Touch, Latch, or Write mode to regions on a track, region automation is written to the regions on that track. When you record region automation in Touch, Latch, or Write mode, and multiple tracks are assigned to the channel strip recording live automation, the following conditions determine where automation is recorded:

- If one track is selected, region automation only writes automation to regions on that track.
- If there are selected regions on one of the tracks, region automation only writes to those selected regions.
- If no track or regions are selected, region automation only writes to the region most recently created.

You can specify the mode that the application switches to after a Write operation has been performed using the Automation Settings pane. See Automation settings.

Adjust automation

Adjust automation points on the automation track and in regions in Logic Pro for Mac

In Logic Pro for Mac, you can adjust individual automation points and MIDI data points on the automation track and in regions to adjust their values or their position on the timeline.

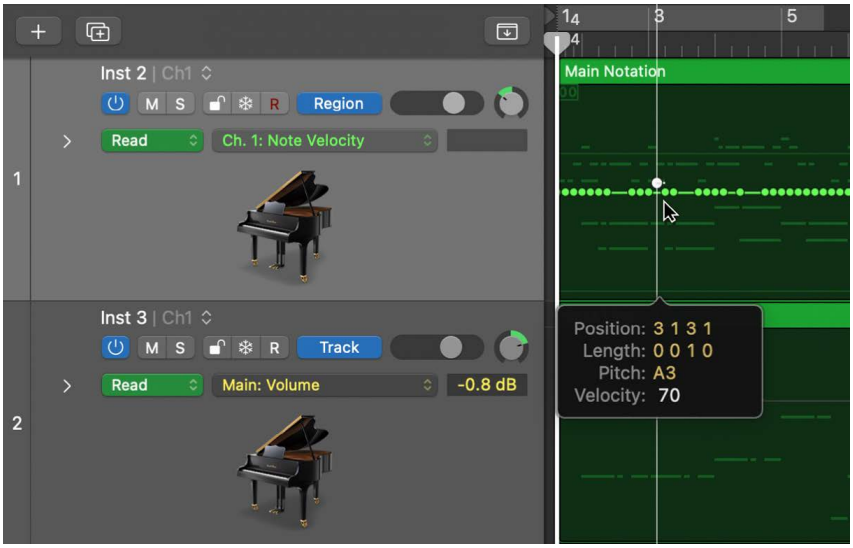
Adjust automation points

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do either of the following:

- Drag an automation point up or down to change its value.
- Drag an automation point left or right to move it to a different point in the timeline. Use the ruler to align automation points with a beat or measure.

Adjust MIDI values in region automation

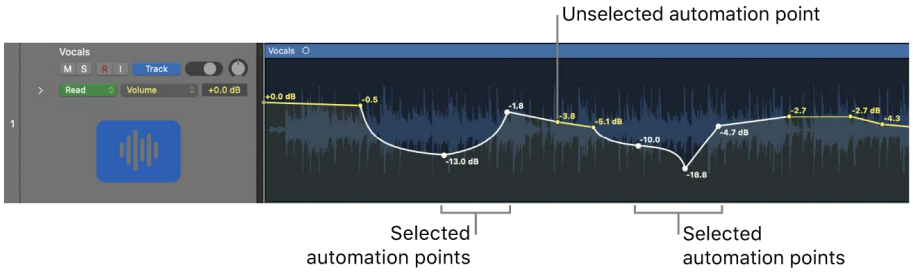
1. With Logic Pro in automation mode, and a MIDI data parameter showing in the Automation Parameter pop-up menu, select a MIDI value.
2. Drag up or down to change the MIDI value or drag left or right to move it to a different point in the timeline.



Note: You can change the format of displayed MIDI values in the Display MIDI Data As pop-up menu in the General View settings.

Adjust a range of automation points in Logic Pro for Mac

In Logic Pro for Mac, you can adjust multiple automation points at once by selecting them first and then moving them as a group. The group of automation points is displayed as a range selection on the automation track, indicated by a gray area between the first and last selected automation points. You can also create multiple selections on the automation curve to adjust a group of non-adjacent automation points at once.



Dragging a group of automation points horizontally changes their position on the timeline. As a default, dragging them vertically moves all selected points up or down equally by the same amount.

The automation trim field in the track header lets you adjust the entire automation curve on an automation track vertically without creating any selection.

Note: If the track is part of a mixer group, the track automation data for the group adjusts in accord with the automation parameter you set in the Group Setting window. See Automate groups.

Select an automation range

With Logic Pro in automation mode, create one or multiple range selections on the automation track by doing any of the following:

- Drag left or right across the automation track to select all automation points in that range.
- Press and hold the Shift key and drag another selection to create additional ranges.
- Shift-click multiple adjacent automation points to create a range from the first to the last selected point.

  The selected automation points and the line between them change to a white color, and the range selection appears as a gray bar on the timeline.
- Shift-click multiple non-adjacent automation points.

Note: Unselected automation points in a selection range are not affected when you adjust the selection vertically or horizontally.

Click in the automation track background to deselect all automation points.

Adjust the time positions of a group of automation points

1. With Logic Pro in automation mode, create a range selection on the automation track.
2. Drag horizontally to move the time position of the selected automation points in that range by doing any of the following:
   - Drag one of the selected automation points.
   - Drag a segment of the selected automation curve.
   - Drag the background of the range selection.

   Once you start dragging horizontally, you cannot move the points vertically (until you release the pointer) to avoid changing their values inadvertently.

Adjust the values of a group of automation points

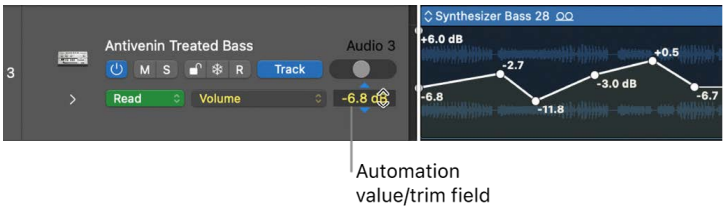
1. With Logic Pro in automation mode, create a range selection on the automation track.
2. Drag vertically to adjust the values of the selected automation points in that range by doing any of the following:
   - Drag one of the selected automation points.
   - Drag a segment of the selected automation curve.
   - Drag the background of the range selection.

In Absolute mode, all selected automation points are moved up or down by the same amount.

Tip: Tip: Press and hold the Control key while dragging vertically to make finer adjustments.

Adjust the entire automation curve vertically

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, after making your selection, place the pointer over the numerical display in the track header (the parameter value changes to Trim), then drag vertically to change the value (the offset or trim amount).



When you adjust a range of automation points, the relative differences in their values are retained. If the value of any of the automation points reaches the minimum or maximum value, none of the values can be adjusted further. You can override this behavior by holding the Option key while dragging.

Tip: If the Trim field is not visible, position the pointer over the line dividing the track headers from the left edge of the tracks, then (when you see the Resize pointer) drag the line left or right to resize the track headers.

When you release the mouse, the numerical display reverts to showing the value of the active automation parameter at the playhead position.

Select, copy, move, and delete automation

Select, copy, and move automation in Logic Pro for Mac

After you create automation points and curves, you can easily change things to meet your needs. You can copy automation within a track or between tracks and can move automation within a track. When moving regions, you can choose whether or not to move any existing automation with it.

You can use the Automation Select and Automation Curve tools to select and bend automation curves.

Select automation

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:

- Drag across any selection of automation points and curves.
- Click the automation curve with the pointer or Automation Select tool.

Select noncontiguous automation

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:

- Press and hold the Shift key and drag across multiple non-contiguous automation points and curves.
- Press and hold the Shift key and click multiple non-contiguous automation points and curves with the pointer or Automation Select tool.

Select specific automation values within a time range

Sometimes you may want to only select a specific range of automation points and curves in a time range, rather than every automation point and curve. You can do this by holding down the Option key.

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, press and hold the Option key and drag across a range of automation curves both vertically to select a value range, and horizontally to select a time range.

  Note: Automation curves connected to points that have been selected also appear selected, even if those curves continue outside the selected range.

Select all automation following an automation point

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:
  - Option-click an automation point to select it and all following automation points.
  - Option-click an automation curve to select all following automation points.

Copy automation within a track

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, select the points or curves you want to copy, then Option-drag the selection to a different location on the track.

Any existing points in the target location are deleted.

Note: Depending on zoom level, it can be challenging to select only the automation you wish to move. Be sure to zoom in on the automation points or curves that you wish to select for best results. See Zoom windows.

Copy automation between tracks

1. With Logic Pro in automation mode, press and hold the Shift key while dragging a selection within the automation area.
2. Choose Edit > Copy (or use the corresponding key command).
3. Select the track you want to copy the automation to.
4. Choose Edit > Paste (or use the corresponding key command).

Move automation

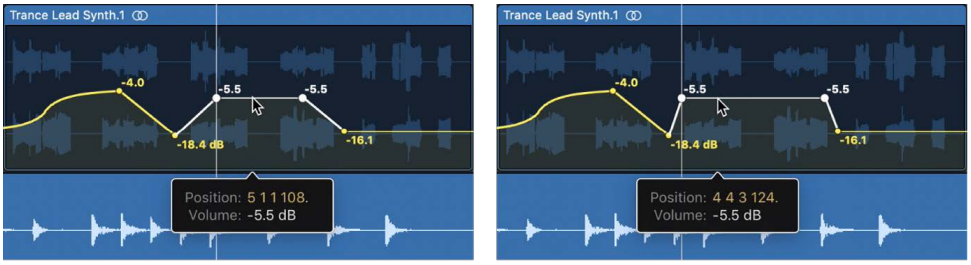
- With Logic Pro in automation mode, select the points or curves you want to move, then drag them horizontally or vertically.

Any existing points in the target location are deleted.

Adjust the ramp time around two adjacent automation points

You can adjust two adjacent automation points to move them closer together or further apart. This is a quick way to simultaneously change the ramp time between the first selected automation point and its previous automation point and the ramp time between the second selected automation point and its following automation point.

1. With Logic Pro in automation mode, select two adjacent automation points.
2. Option-Shift-drag the selected automation curve horizontally to move the two points in opposite directions.



Create a vertical automation line

When the display shows two automation points with different values connected by a vertical automation curve—in other words, they occur at the same moment—it creates the effect of an instant parameter change. This can be useful if you wish to create an "instant on" or "instant off" type of effect, rather than a gradual parameter change.

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, drag an automation point or curve to the left, toward an automation point with a higher or lower value.

  The automation point you are dragging snaps to a position directly above or below the stationary automation point.

You can also drag an automation point to the right toward an automation point with a higher or lower value, but the automation point you are dragging does not snap into a vertical automation line.

Move regions with or without automation

- In Logic Pro, choose one of the following Move Automation with Regions options in Logic Pro > Settings > Automation:
  - *Never:* Does not move automation when you move regions.
  - *Always:* Always moves automation when you move regions. The automation area encompassed by the region boundaries is moved.
  - *Ask:* A dialog prompts you to move the automation—or leave it where it is—whenever you move a region.

You can also access these options using the shortcut menu that appears when you Control-click the track lane.

Move a region selection with its automation

1. In Logic Pro, drag across the region with the Marquee tool.
2. Choose Edit > Copy from the Tracks area menu bar.
3. Select the track you want to copy the automation data to, then move the playhead to the insertion point.
4. Choose Edit > Paste from the Tracks area menu bar.

The region selection, along with its automation, is copied to the target track at the playhead position.

Bend an automation curve

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:

- Drag an automation curve with the Automation Curve tool.



- Press and hold Control-Shift while dragging an automation curve with the Pointer tool.

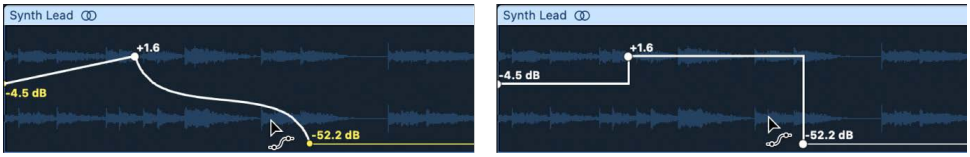
Change an automation curve into stepped automation

Normally, an automation curve between two automation points represents continuously changing parameter values. Using the Automation Curve tool, you can change any automation curve into stepped automation.

A stepped automation curve between two automation points has a slightly thinner line than a curved automation curve.

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:

- Option-click an automation curve with the Automation Curve tool. Option-click the automation curve with the Automation Curve tool again to return the automation curve to its previous state.



- Control-Option-Shift-click an automation curve with the Pointer tool. Control-Option-Shift-click the automation curve again to return the automation curve to its previous state.

Delete automation in Logic Pro for Mac

You can delete individual automation points, multiple automation points, or use a number of commands to delete automation across tracks.

Delete a single automation point

With Logic Pro in automation mode, do one of the following:

- Double-click the automation point.
- Select the automation point, then press Delete.
- Drag across the automation point with the Eraser tool.

Delete multiple automation points

- With Logic Pro in automation mode, select multiple automation points with the Pointer, Automation Select, or Marquee tool, then press Delete.

Delete automation using commands

- In Logic Pro, choose one of the following options from Mix > Delete Automation:
  - *Delete Visible Automation on Selected Track:* Removes automation for the active automation parameter.
  - *Delete All Automation on Selected Track:* Removes all automation from the selected track.
  - *Delete Orphaned Automation on Selected Track:* Removes all orphaned automation from the selected track. Automation can become orphaned when copied between tracks.
  - *Delete Redundant Automation Points:* Removes all redundant automation points on all regions and tracks.
  - *Delete All Track Automation:* Removes all automation from all tracks.

Note: You can also use key commands for all the delete commands in the Mix menu except Delete All Track Automation.

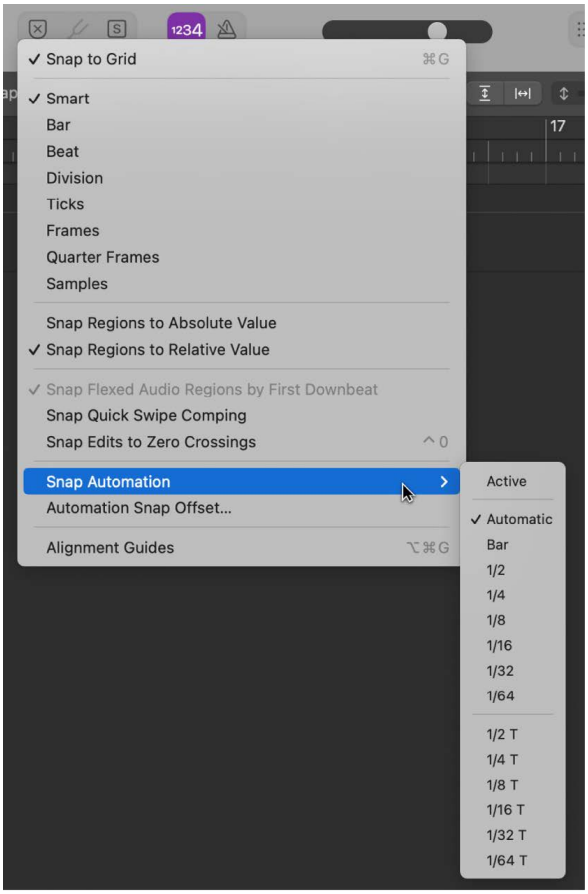
Snap automation to grid position in Logic Pro for Mac

You can use snap automation to move automation points to precise positions on the grid. Snap automation can be set independently in the Tracks area and the Piano Roll Editor.

When snap automation is on, you can also offset automation, by moving it slightly forward or backward in time. Offsetting automation helps compensate for any audio hardware latencies, excessive processor loads, or plug-in delays.

Snap automation points to the chosen Snap Automation value

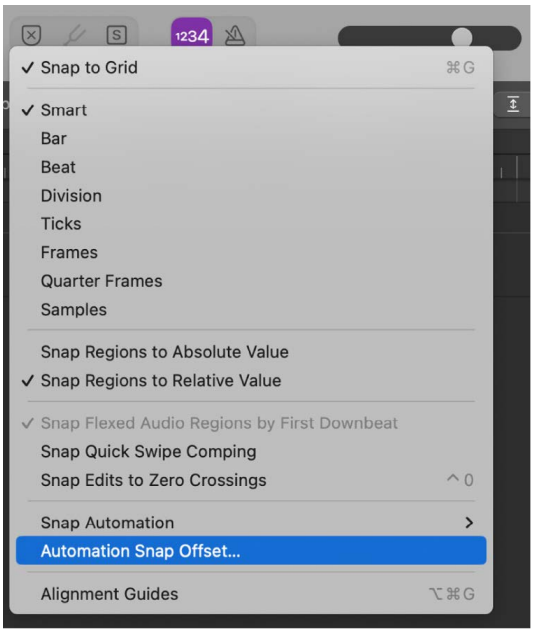
- In Logic Pro, choose Snap Automation from the Snap pop-up menu and select a value from the submenu.



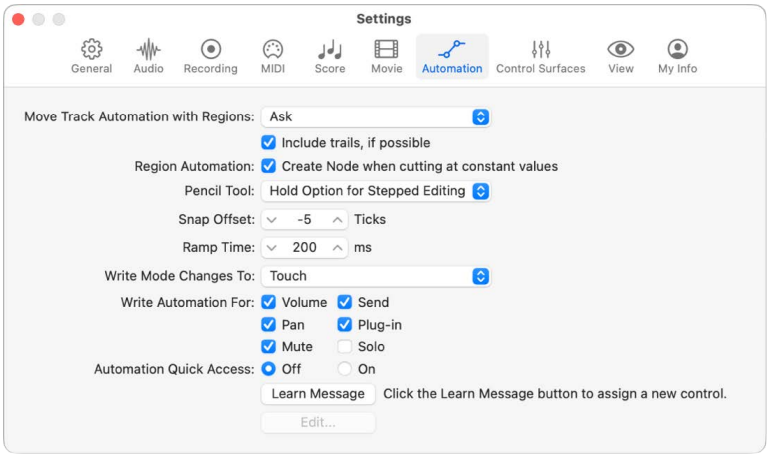
Automation edits snap to the value chosen in the Snap Automation submenu.

Offset automation when Snap Automation is active

1. In Logic Pro, choose Automation Snap Offset from the Snap pop-up menu.



2. Adjust the Snap Offset parameter in tick values (can be positive or negative).



All automation on all tracks is offset by the chosen number of ticks.

Edit in the Automation Event List in Logic Pro for Mac

You can edit automation in a dedicated Automation Event List window. This floating list window includes only recorded automation data, unlike the standard Event list that includes all recorded MIDI data and can be either a floating window or one of the List Editors in the main window.

Open the Automation Event List window

- In Logic Pro, use the Track Automation Event List key command (default assignment: Control-Command-E).

  Note: You may need to assign this key command in the Key Command Editor in order to use it. See Assign key commands.

Edit track automation

- In Logic Pro, Edit individual events in the Automation Event List window. You can edit the position, length, value, and so on, of your automation data in this window.

Write automation with controllers in Logic Pro for Mac

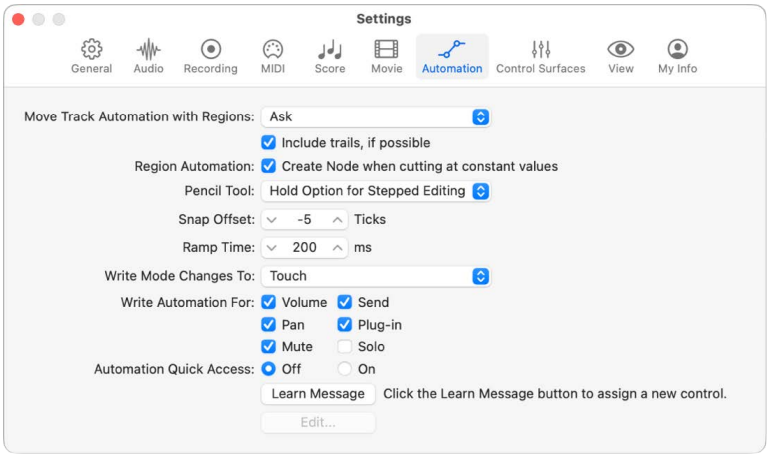
Logic Pro for Mac provides support for a number of dedicated control surfaces that make writing and editing track automation fast, efficient, and easy. Depending on the facilities available, you can simultaneously write automation for several channels, or multiple plug-in parameters. Any MIDI controller—such as the modulation wheel, or a front panel slider or knob on your MIDI keyboard—can be used to write automation. You can use one such controller for all automation writing duties, or you can assign individual controllers (if available on your MIDI keyboard) to different parameters.

The Automation Quick Access (AQA) feature makes track automation extremely fast and simple if you only have one hardware MIDI controller available—one fader on your MIDI keyboard, or just the modulation wheel, for example. You can use this single hardware controller to automate the currently active automation parameter of the selected track in the main window.

Set up Automation Quick Access

1. Choose Logic Pro > Settings > Automation.

   In the Automation pane, Automation Quick Access is turned off by default.



2. Click the On button in the Automation Quick Access section.

   A dialog prompts you to assign a controller.

3. Click the Assign button and slowly move the hardware controller that you want to use for Automation Quick Access. Make sure that it's moved through its entire range.
4. Confirm your selection by clicking the Done button below the Off/On buttons in the Automation Quick Access section.

   The Done button changes into a Learn Message button. Click the Learn Message button to assign a new controller for Automation Quick Access. Clicking the Edit button opens the Controller Assignments window, where you can assign the controller manually. See the Logic Pro for Mac Control Surfaces Support guide for more information. Once set up, you have hardware control over the active automation parameter on the current track.

Tip: If you choose the modulation wheel for Automation Quick Access, you might want to switch between using it for Automation Quick Access and normal modulation wheel duties—as MIDI controller 1. You can do this quickly using the Toggle Automation Quick Access key command (or pressing Control-Option-Command-A).